

THE MILLENNIAL MYTH

After graduating from college with serious debt, I applied for many jobs I was not qualified for. Now that I wasn't in school, I wanted the *Boston Globe* to hire me full time, and they'd made clear they weren't into that idea. Even if they wouldn't hire you, you could still come in and work as many part-time shifts as your schedule allowed, *but* you were technically still freelancing. There were a couple of older guys working there who were still doing the same desk work as us recent grads, hoping to get hired. No one wanted to be them, so everyone worked there a little and applied to other jobs a lot.

First, I hit up an old college professor about a job at the *Boston Business Journal* making Flash animations, something I barely knew how to do. My prospects there seemed good, but I knew that if I got the job, I'd be spending most of my time convincing myself (and my bosses) I wasn't hired as a mistake. Before I even knew if I got that job, I stubbornly moved back to New York instead. I was determined to turn my unpaid struggles at *The Daily Show* into a full-time gig either at Comedy Central or somewhere else in the city. I was desperate to convince myself it had all been worth it. (This was when I tried for coffee with all my old Viacom bosses, which ended up being a dead end.)

It was December 2009. I was living outside the city on my brother and his wife's couch. I applied for jobs at every publication in New York. The days turned to weeks of rejections. Everyone suggested I hit up anyone I had ever met. I reached out to college alumni I found in the Emerson newsletter, people I knew from the high school newspaper job, and my dad's AA acquaintances. I emailed friends of friends, people Meme had met once at the nail salon, a distant cousin my dad heard lived in New York, his old college professor, a circus clown my friend's uncle roomed with in college. These might be slight exaggerations, but you get it: None of those emails or calls led to anything.